

TidyTuesday Week 33

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Friday 14th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where a computer picks two economic series out of a hat, mashes them together, and I pretend to be surprised by the results. This week we bravely paired the price of services with a discontinued overnight lending rate, Swiss central bank shenanigans from the 1970s with modern manufacturing order ratios, Asian air freight costs with restaurant job postings, and – my personal favorite – the average size of a medium-term bank loan with the growth rate of the entire national income. Truly the pairings of destiny.

Monday's contestant (August 10) came out swinging with a raw R-squared of 0.93, which for a hobby project is roughly the statistical equivalent of a slot machine paying out on the first pull. Chained services prices and a one-week interest rate marching in lockstep! Call the newspapers! Except, of course, both series were quietly drifting along over time, and the moment we stripped that drift out, the R-squared face-planted from 0.93 down to a limp 0.23. It's still technically "significant" in the detrended version, so I won't fully dunk on it, but let's be honest: that 0.93 was 99 percent shared trend and 1 percent actual acquaintance. Classic trend mirage, gone the instant you make it prove itself.

August 12 deserves a special mention for being the most dramatically useless result of the week: Swiss National Bank dollar purchases against the Deutsche Mark versus manufacturers' unfilled-orders ratios produced an R-squared of approximately 0.0000000000000003 and a coefficient of literally zero. The model was so confused it flagged a singular design matrix, which is math's polite way of saying "there is nothing here, please go home." The other two days were equally sleepy – air freight and food-service job postings couldn't clear the significance bar in either the raw OR detrended version (p-values loitering around 0.19 and 0.11), and loan sizes versus real gross domestic income mustered an R-squared of 0.02 that collapsed to essentially nothing once detrended. Real income growth, it turns out, does not care about the size of your low-risk bank loan. Shocking.

As always, the mandatory reminder: these series were paired at random, and any relationship you see is almost certainly the universe's idea of a practical joke rather than evidence of anything. The whole point of this exercise is that spurious correlation is the house specialty – I am not claiming Swiss currency interventions cause factory backlogs, nor that services inflation is secretly puppeteering discontinued interest rates. When even the one flashy 0.93 result crumbles the moment we ask it to work for a living, you know we're firmly in "for entertainment purposes only" territory. See you next week for more statistical nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-08-10

Series ID: SUUR0000SAS

This series is titled Chained Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1999=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1999-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: AMBOR1W

This series is titled 1-Week AMERIBOR Term Structure of Interest Rates (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2021-06-20 and the observation end date is 2023-12-27. The popularity of this series is 2.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W	R-squared:	0.930			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.927			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	319.1			
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.29e-15			
Time:	12:39:09	Log-Likelihood:	-23.378			
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	50.76			
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	53.27			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	-50.4524	2.976	-16.953	0.000	-56.595	-44.310
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS	0.2849	0.016	17.863	0.000	0.252	0.318
Omnibus:	3.117	Durbin-Watson:	0.261			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.210	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.425			
Skew:	-0.614	Prob(JB):	0.297			
Kurtosis:	2.147	Cond. No.	4.58e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.58e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

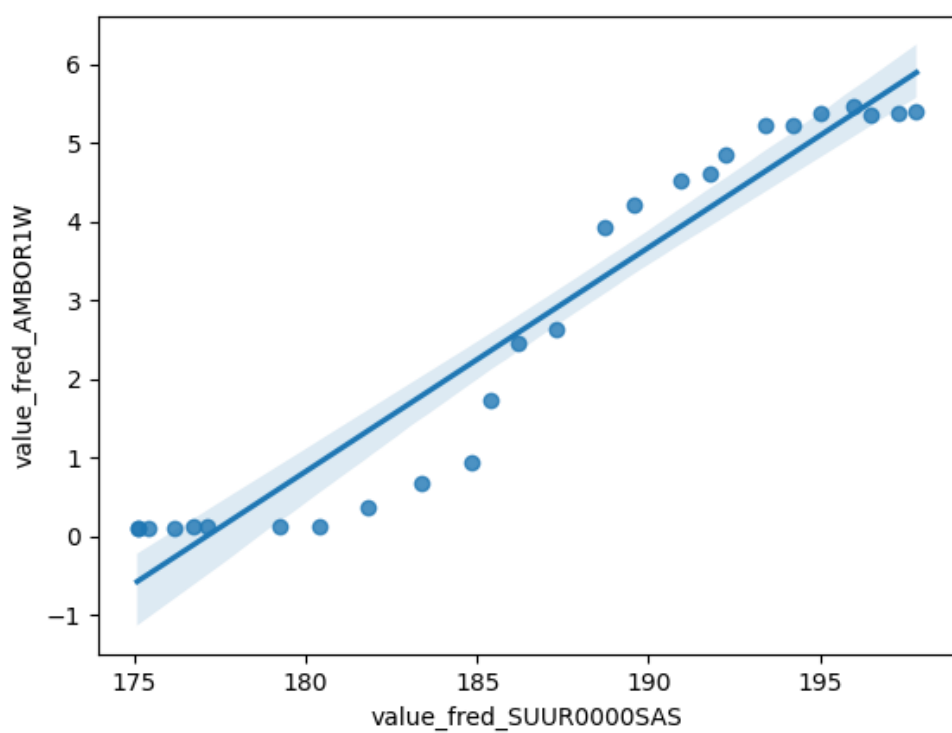


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_AMBOR1W_detrended	R-squared:	0.227
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.195
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	7.062
Date:	Mon, 10 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0138
Time:	12:39:09	Log-Likelihood:	-23.173
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	50.35
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	52.86
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.455e-11	0.120	-1.21e-10	1.000	-0.249	0.249
value_fred_SUUR0000SAS_detrended	0.3703	0.139	2.657	0.014	0.083	0.658

Omnibus:	3.443	Durbin-Watson:	0.285
Prob(Omnibus):	0.179	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.012
Skew:	-0.790	Prob(JB):	0.222
Kurtosis:	2.467	Cond. No.	1.16

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

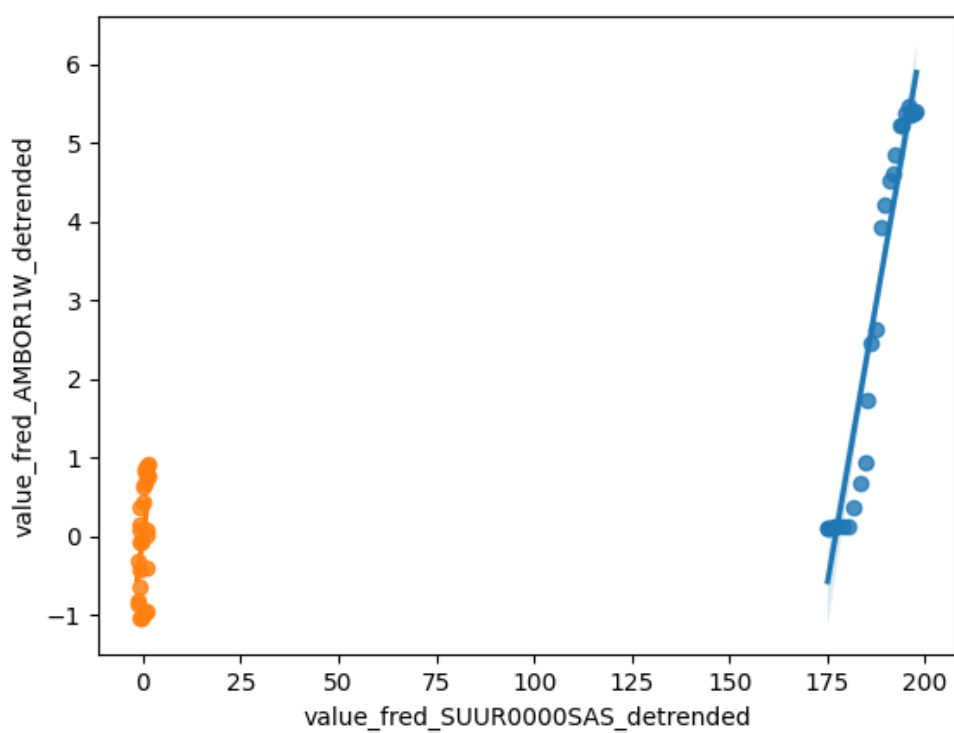


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-10

3 Date: 2026-08-12

Series ID: CHINTDUSDDM

This series is titled Swiss Intervention: Swiss National Bank Purchases of USD against DEM (Millions of USD) and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Millions of USD and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1975-01-01 and the observation end date is 1998-12-31. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: U36SUS

This series is titled Manufacturers' Unfilled Orders to Shipments Ratios: Transportation Equipment and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Ratio and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1992-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:39:50	Log-Likelihood:	-151.34
No. Observations:	84	AIC:	304.7
Df Residuals:	83	BIC:	307.1
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	9.3852	0.161	58.316	0.000	9.065	9.705
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	19.125	Durbin-Watson:	1.105
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	23.295
Skew:	1.168	Prob(JB):	8.74e-06
Kurtosis:	4.095	Cond. No.	inf

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The smallest eigenvalue is 0. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

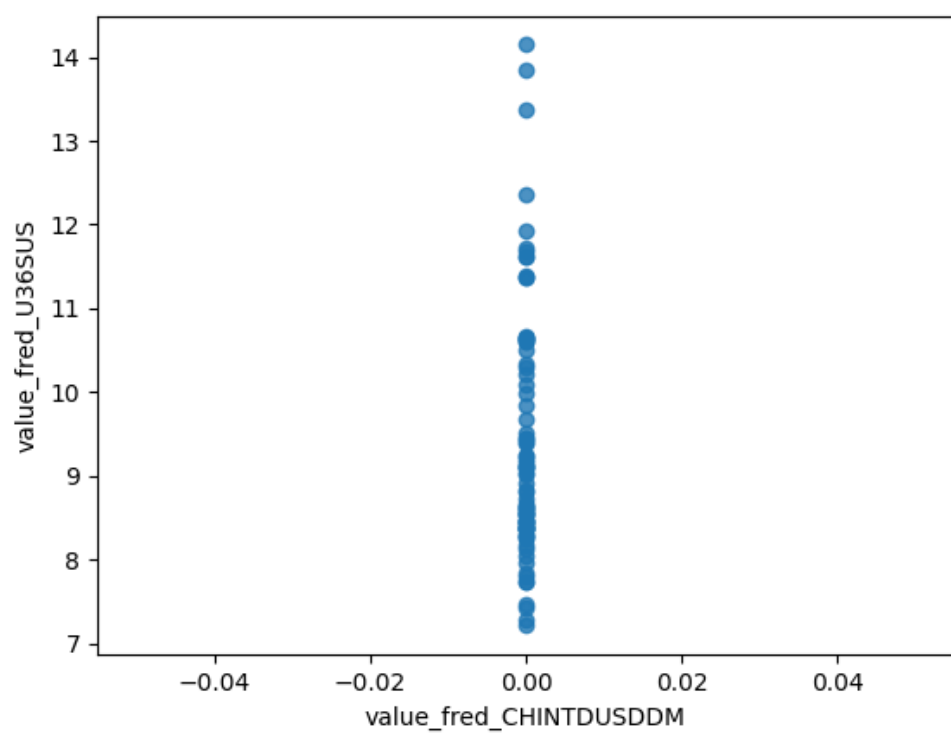


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-12

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_U36SUS_detrended	R-squared:	0.000
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.000
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Wed, 12 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:39:50	Log-Likelihood:	-134.10
No. Observations:	84	AIC:	270.2
Df Residuals:	83	BIC:	272.6
Df Model:	0		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-8.19e-13	0.131	-6.25e-12	1.000	-0.261	0.261
value_fred_CHINTDUSDDM_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	21.603	Durbin-Watson:	1.662
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	27.747
Skew:	1.266	Prob(JB):	9.44e-07
Kurtosis:	4.233	Cond. No.	inf

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The smallest eigenvalue is 0. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity problems or that the design matrix is singular.

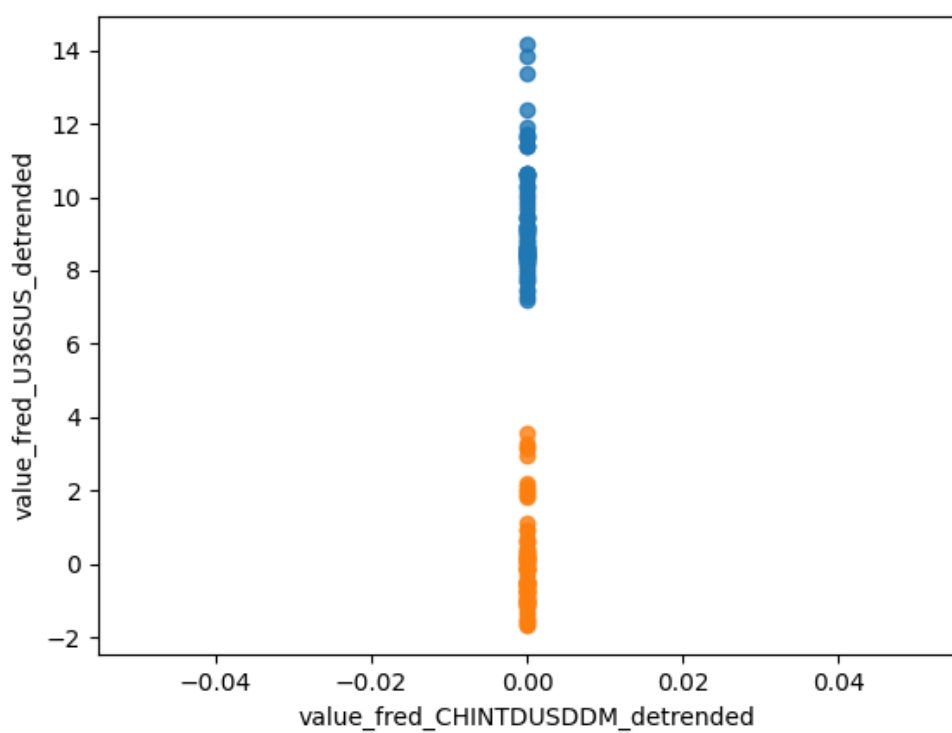


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-12

4 Date: 2026-08-13

Series ID: IV1312

This series is titled Import Price Index (Balance of Payments): Air Freight for Asia and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1990-09-01 and the observation end date is 2026-06-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE

This series is titled Food Preparation and Service Job Postings on Indeed in the United States and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are Index Feb, 1 2020=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2020-02-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-07. The popularity of this series is 6.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE	R-squared:	0.023
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.010
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.750
Date:	Thu, 13 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.190
Time:	12:40:03	Log-Likelihood:	-335.82
No. Observations:	76	AIC:	675.6
Df Residuals:	74	BIC:	680.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	95.2838	12.490	7.629	0.000	70.398	120.170
value_fred_IV1312	0.0574	0.043	1.323	0.190	-0.029	0.144

Omnibus:	8.845	Durbin-Watson:	0.102
Prob(Omnibus):	0.012	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.702
Skew:	-0.813	Prob(JB):	0.0129
Kurtosis:	3.319	Cond. No.	1.54e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.54e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

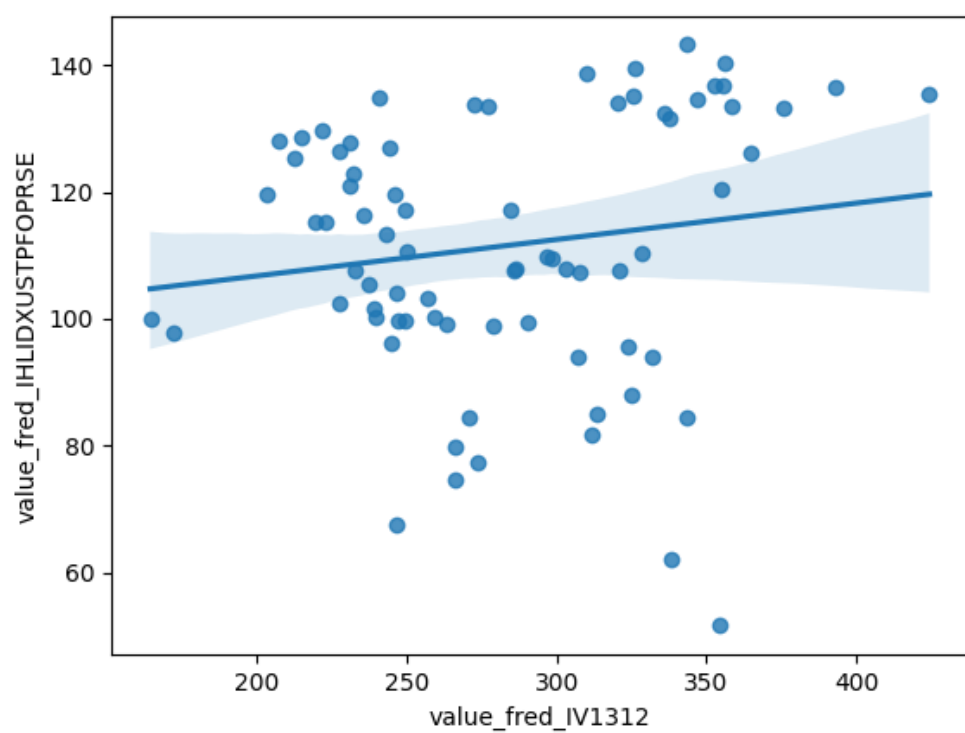


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-13

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IHLIDXUSTPFOPRSE_detrended	R-squared:	0.034
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.021
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.578
Date:	Thu, 13 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.113
Time:	12:40:03	Log-Likelihood:	-335.22
No. Observations:	76	AIC:	674.4
Df Residuals:	74	BIC:	679.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.576e-11	2.316	-6.81e-12	1.000	-4.614	4.614
value_fred_IV1312_detrended	0.0727	0.045	1.605	0.113	-0.018	0.163

Omnibus:	4.621	Durbin-Watson:	0.113
Prob(Omnibus):	0.099	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.541
Skew:	-0.592	Prob(JB):	0.103
Kurtosis:	2.825	Cond. No.	51.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

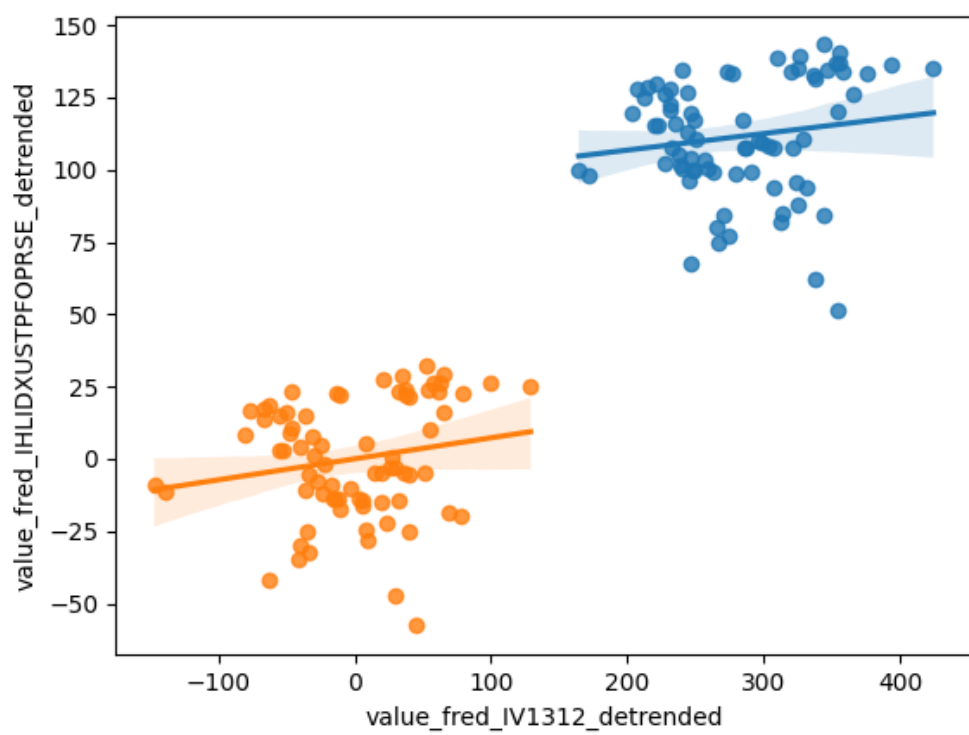


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-13

5 Date: 2026-08-14

Series ID: EAMLXDBNQ

This series is titled Average Loan Size for 31 to 365 Days, Low Risk, Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Thousands of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: A261RL1Q225SBEA

This series is titled Real Gross Domestic Income and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Percent Change from Preceding Period and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1947-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 27.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_A261RL1Q225SBEA	R-squared:	0.020			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.008			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.629			
Date:	Fri, 14 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.206			
Time:	12:37:50	Log-Likelihood:	-202.51			
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	409.0			
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	413.8			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.9300	0.515	5.689	0.000	1.905	3.955
value_fred_EAMLXDBNQ	-0.0008	0.001	-1.276	0.206	-0.002	0.000
Omnibus:	20.575	Durbin-Watson:	1.219			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	31.073			
Skew:	-1.046	Prob(JB):	1.79e-07			
Kurtosis:	5.198	Cond. No.	1.26e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.26e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

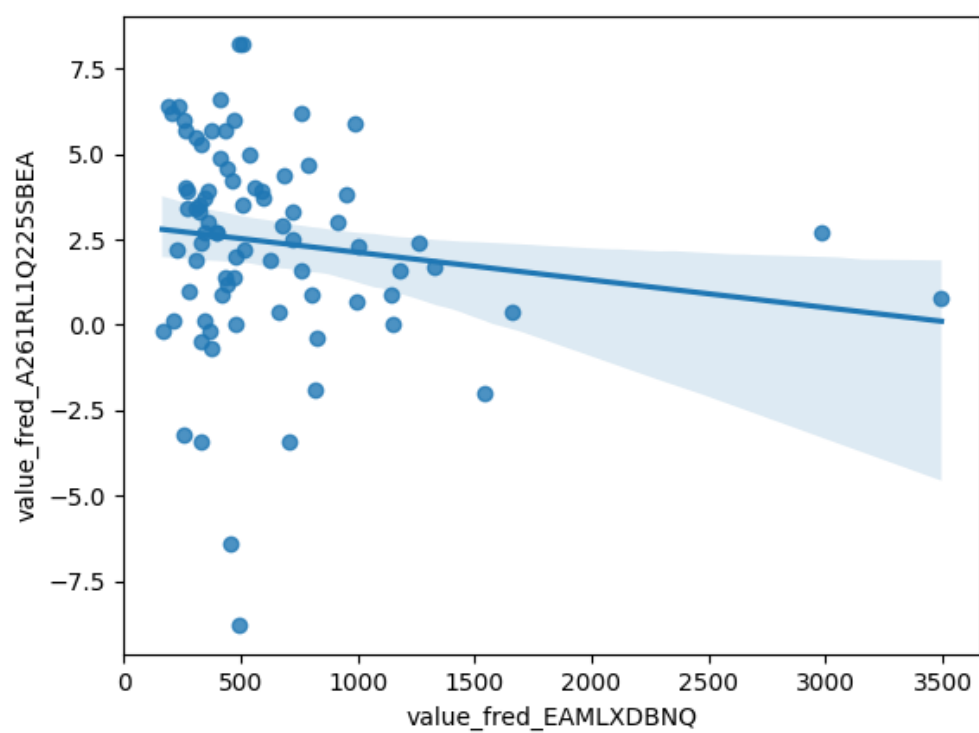


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-14

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_A261RL1Q225SBEA_detrended	R-squared:	0.003
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.010
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.2417
Date:	Fri, 14 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.624
Time:	12:37:51	Log-Likelihood:	-200.76
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	405.5
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	410.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.173e-13	0.325	6.7e-13	1.000	-0.646	0.646
value_fred_EAMLXDBNQ_detrended	-0.0003	0.001	-0.492	0.624	-0.002	0.001

Omnibus:	21.332	Durbin-Watson:	1.245
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	33.382
Skew:	-1.063	Prob(JB):	5.64e-08
Kurtosis:	5.318	Cond. No.	484.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

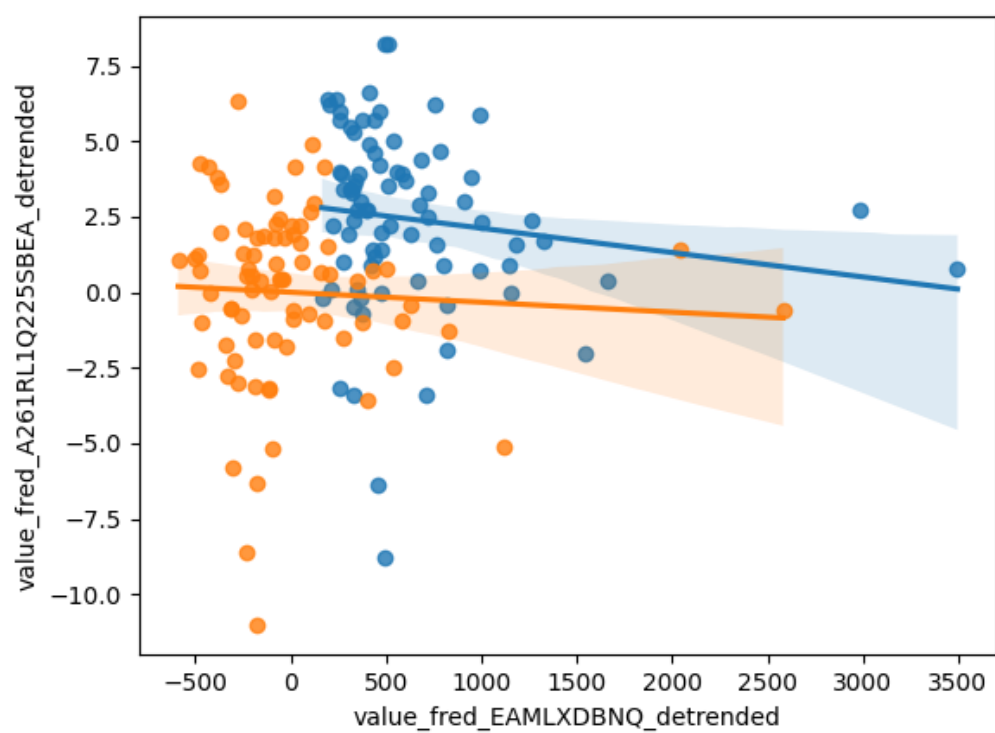


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-14